



FAMILY GROUP

A 1781 painting by the Austrian artist Johann Nepomuk della Croce shows Leopold Mozart holding a violin, with his children Wolfgang and Nannerl seated at the piano. A portrait of their deceased mother hangs on the wall.

An independent spirit

In 1778, at his father's urging, Mozart again embarked on his travels in search of wealthy patronage. Leopold stayed in Salzburg, worried he might lose his post if he went away again, and Mozart was instead accompanied by his mother. In Paris—a foreign city in which they were friendless and isolated—disaster struck: Mozart's mother died of a sudden illness. His father irrationally blamed Wolfgang, who returned to Salzburg. From this point, Mozart became set on escaping from his father's controlling influence.